OEI INSTITUTE | INFORMATION PACKET

About the Operational Entropy Index

A governed methodology for investigating operational strain and supporting responsible action

The Institute governs. The method investigates.

The OEI Institute maintains the Operational Entropy Index canon and practice standards. OEI gives organizations a shared way to examine how strain develops as work, people, and systems grow.

What the OEI examines

Operational entropy is friction and unnecessary complexity that accumulate in how work gets done. It can appear as delayed decisions, fragmented knowledge, slow or restarted workflows, tool workarounds, or failed handoffs. OEI examines operating conditions through evidence rather than relying on a single perspective.

The five OEI pillars

Founder Dependency

Reliance on key people for decisions, context, or continuity.

Knowledge Logistics

Whether critical information reaches people in usable form.

Workflow Velocity

Where work waits, stalls, restarts, or accumulates rework.

Tool Discipline

Whether tools support the work or create more friction.

Handoff Integrity

Whether ownership and context transfer reliably.

How OEI builds a useful picture

Gather evidence

Structured interviews and operational records bring multiple perspectives into view.

Trace real work

Workflow mapping follows decisions, information, tools, dependencies, and handoffs.

Test what happens

Operational samples help distinguish stated process from observed practice.

Connect causes

Root-cause mapping links visible friction to the conditions producing it.

From investigation to application

OEI supports a clearer response by separating what is observed, what it may mean, and what the evidence can support.

What OEI can produce

A baseline

A structured view of the operating condition and relevant OEI pillars.

A causal map

Evidence connecting observed friction with its underlying conditions.

Priorities

A grounded view of where action is most likely to improve the work.

A way to learn

Measures that help teams assess whether an intervention improves operations.

How organizations work with OEI

Build internal capability

The Company-Sponsored pathway trains two different people, one Researcher and one Practitioner.

Work with practitioners

Independent Consultants serve their own clients. OEI Native Practitioners deliver engagements for the Institute.

Focused investigations examine a bounded operating condition. Entropy Compatible Hiring (ECH) is a separate software product that supports structured hiring interviews and existing-employee contribution mapping; it can be used independently of a formal OEI engagement.

Researcher and Practitioner pathways

Researchers make operational reality legible through evidence. Practitioners determine what the evidence supports and lead diagnosis and recommendations. Company-Sponsored trains two people for $10,000. Independent Consultant trains one person for both roles for $12,000. OEI Native qualifies a Practitioner to deliver for the Institute for $15,000. Each pathway is 60% upfront for non-refundable training and assessment. Passing earns role certification and authorization. The remaining 40% is due only after passing. First-year renewal is waived. Annual renewal is $500 per internally employed Company-Sponsored Practitioner, $600 for Independent Consultants, and $750 for OEI Native Practitioners. Researchers have no renewal fee. Full terms: operationalentropy.com/practitioner-development/.